Characteristics of Model I

1. Decision variables for each land management unit each represent a management option for the unit over the entire planning horizon.

2. Decision variables for the formulation take the form:

   X_{ij}= # of land units of management unit *i* assigned to *j*th prescription for stand *i*.

3. If rotation lengths can be short and the planning horizon is long, the number of decision variables for a single management unit can be quite large. Some systematic way of specifying the options is needed.

4. Tables like the following are often been used to describe the decision variables. For this example the minimum rotation length is two periods. Each "H" in the table represents a final harvest or the end of one rotation. Thinning options are not considered in this example.

Period	Alternative #																			
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21
1														H	H	H	H	H	H	H	H
2									H	H	H	H	H								
3						H	H	H											H	H	H
4				H	H							H	H				H	H			
5			H					H			H					H					H
6		H			H		H			H			H		H			H		H	